



Jargon Buster

Aperture Grille: Invented by Sony, this technology uses a series of thin, closely-spaced, vertical wires, to isolate the pixels horizontally. To keep the vertical wires in an Aperture Grille properly aligned within the picture tube, one or two horizontal 'damper' wires are required. Monitors manufactured with Aperture Grille are sharper and clearer.

Colour temperature: This is the amount of white on the screen, and is measured in degrees Kelvin. Colours used in images such as landscapes, or pictures of people, look better when displayed at a colour temperature of 6500 K. However, regular black text on a white background is better displayed at 9300 K.

Sharpness or Convergence: This refers to the convergence of the three different electron guns—red, green and blue. The closer the dots fall, the sharper the image is.

Dot pitch: This is the distance from the centre of one phosphor dot to the centre of the nearest dot of the same colour, on the line directly above or beneath. The closer the dots are, the smaller the dot pitch, and the sharper the images.

High voltage regulation: This is the ability of high voltage to respond to changes in current. Good high voltage regulation means a stable display, even when changing intensity levels.

Horizontal Scan Frequency (Scan rate): The number of lines illuminated on a video screen in one second, or how fast each of the horizontal lines that make up the display are scanned, measured in kilohertz (KHz). High scan rates are required to provide sharper images at higher resolutions.

Interlaced and Non-Interlaced: In order to create a picture on the screen, the screen is divided into lines that get illuminated. In non-interlaced mode, the lines are illuminated sequentially, several times a second. In interlaced mode, the lines are not continuous—they are in two sets, alternating with each other, both sets being illuminated at the same time. This translates to flicker.

Magnetic field effect: A steel cabinet or desk, or magnetically unshielded speakers, may interfere with the picture tube's electron beams. This causes the screen to show myriad hues of blue or red.

Persistence of vision: This is the ability of the human eye to retain an image after the image has been taken off the screen. Contrasting screens, such as a black screen shown immediately after a white screen, or the movement of a white block on a black background, illustrates this phenomenon.

Pincushion: This is the effect of the inward curve of a video image, like an hourglass. All monitors experience this to an extent.

Pixel: Short for picture element, a pixel is a single point in a graphic image. Monitors display pictures by dividing the display screen into thousands (or millions) of pixels, arranged in rows and columns. It is the smallest point on a screen that can be illuminated. A pixel may only be one colour at any given time, so the image you see is the sum of all the pixels on the screen. The more the pixels, the better the resolution.

ShadowMask: This is a thin screen full of holes, attached to the back of a colour CRT's viewing glass. The electron beam is aimed through the holes in the mask onto the phosphor dots.



Philips	Samsung
109P4	SyncMaster 955DF
19	19
18	18
Y	Y
0.24	0.26
50 - 160	50 - 160
30 - 110	30 - 85
1920 x 1440 @ 60	1600 x 1200 @ 68
261	135
Aperture Grille	ShadowMask
456 x 469 x 439	440 x 454 x 461
23.5	19
Y	N
Y	Y
Manual, driver CD, iKey and LightFrame 3 software	Manual, driver CD
3.75	3
19.25	5
23.5	18.25
4	3.75
28.75	31.5
18	16.75
32	16
41.45	30.95
73.45	46.95
2.38	1.76
18,500	16,000
C+	C+

Samsung SyncMaster 150MPplus

The Samsung SyncMaster 150MPplus is Samsung's 15-inch multifunction monitor. As a monitor, it's just vanilla, but take a look at its features, and you're sure to be impressed. It comes with an inbuilt TV tuner.

The 150MPplus is loaded with additional features: watching movies is enhanced with the PIP feature. You can control the sound from the remote; in fact, you can control everything with the remote. The inbuilt TV tuner lets the SyncMaster 150MPplus function just like a normal TV, with channel scan, fine tuning, colour control and user settings to boot. Even the remote looks like the ones Samsung bundles with their TVs.

All necessary wires and accessories, plus an extensively documented manual, are bundled. All input devices can be connected simultaneously, and you can use the source button on the monitor and remote to toggle between



each source. Another function is the image quality, which adjusts the image according to the viewing needs, and makes the image sharper or softer.

If you're interested in a 15-inch LCD that can double as a TV without the hassle of setting up a TV tuner, this is a monitor you should consider.

+ Very good display quality
- Expensive

Price: Rs 35,400